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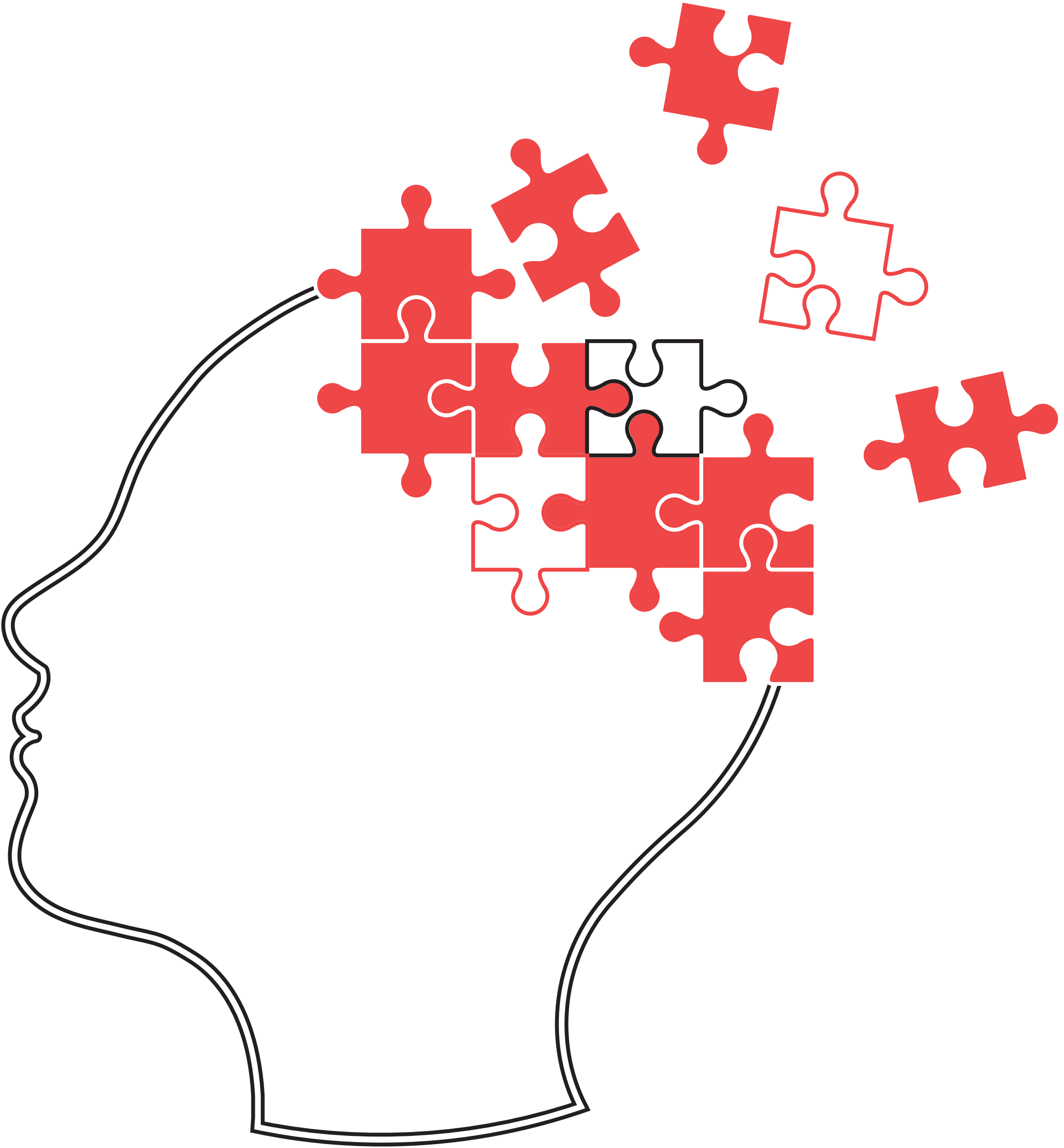
2020

# Inside the

mind of

AN IDEATOR



# What he brings to the table?

A labyrinth around two straight points makes the travelling unnecessarily tedious. We humans have a tendency to create perplexing mazes with our preconceived notions, long held beliefs, dogmas and rigid perceptions. A complex system may not always achieve the fundamental objectives for which it was established in the first place. Democracy is one such system, a complex one, aimed to achieve something very fundamental to life and existence.

Let's get to the fundamentals of the state. In early times, every individual was born free, free to use his ability to the optimum, within all the existing natural limitations. Each man was his own police, judge and jury. (Linder, 2005) So, how did the state emerge? It wasn't a social contract as many philosophers believe. It was the evolution of a very human characteristic, a natural human tendency of finding a common leader. A couple of examples can further explain.

If a group of men are caught in the same problem, they would make the one with the best understanding of the problem to be their leader.

When involved in any group activities of daily life, it is quite evident that we tend to make leaders from those who show up maximum ability in that activity.

Therefore, humans because of this human tendency found a head among themselves. The head and the subjects felt the need to offer the head help through a governing system. Power corrupts, and the leader, naturally, took steps to become more powerful. Aristocracy originated most naturally out of this. Organization between individuals created powerful groups. Other groups, different in culture, language, colour or religion felt threatened and nature started balancing power. Various groups under such organized systems emerged. They fought among themselves and the fittest survived.

The system evolved into democracy, where the objective was to give every individual a say in the rule, where the government will think about the welfare of its people, where a state will provide all the basic necessities of life to an individual. From here comes the concept of a welfare state. But what are the two most fundamental purposes of a state and in which order of priority?

First, a state should aim at offering individuals maximum liberty with minimum interference. It is important to note that all

Individuals live together in a society and therefore, the state also has to ensure that they don't interfere with each other's liberties. Here lies the basic purpose of law and regulation.

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# WRITER | CopyEditor

# START TIMELINE.

RESEARCHER

# THE MUCH-MISUNDERSTOOD TEE TOTALER

**EVERYONE WEARS HIM ON THE SLEEVE, BUT THAT'S ALL THAT IS LEFT OF CHE GUEVARA. FYI TRAILED THE LEGEND THROUGH TOWN, AND FOUND HOW SOME STILL THINK HE WAS A WRESTLER, IF NOT A ROCK STAR**

PEOPLE

**ICONIC INDULGENCE:** (Top left): Gerard Malanga's infamous 1968 Warhol forgery of Che Guevara. When Warhol heard of the fraud, he shrewdly authenticated the fake, so that all the money from sales went to him, and (right) street graffiti of Che Guevara wearing himself on a T-shirt, in Bergen, Norway.

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Trends come; fashion goes. But Che stays. Walking through the parade of humanity, Delhi's street markets present you with an opportunity to revisit the once revolutionary hero, who is all but an enigmatic expression of rebellion today. Just a face. And farce. He's on top of store racks, and top of ignorance charts, too. Che Guevara has been used to market Rage Against the Machine's music; endorses a New York grunge label and almost everything, from mugs and scarves to bags and even thongs, but it's a pity how less his proud wearers know of him.

When we stopped those who were shopping for pop art based on the enigma, the results were shocking. Some think Che Guevara is a rock star, while others assume he was a wrestler. A guest even tried to justify his ignorance: "We wear things that are attractive. We are not here to make sense out of them." And so, they continue to purchase over-priced memorabilia from upmarket fashion stores and local boutiques. Both domestic and international brands, including Tantra, Lee and Archies, have been looking to extract maximum mileage from Che's popularity in India. And yet, the same people who wear him seem to know nothing of his historical stature and character, barring, of course, the boy clan that lives on rock and roll. When a Guevara tee was requested for, at an upscale shop, the storekeeper looked confused and perplexed; he didn't know what we were was talking about. At another shop, the manager brought the T-shirts but couldn't recognise the man on them. A cool customer who walked in, too, failed the test. "Oh yeah, I've seen him. Some rock guy, I think," he shrugged, before getting back to his girlfriend's call.

Nevertheless, there's the revolutionary lot that gets furious when accused of lack of knowledge of the man who's rocked their shirts since over a decade. Political people and university students, in particular, who have heard or read about him, are captivated by the romanticism that surrounds the story of a young medical student raised in a wealthy home, leaving it all to bring justice for the impoverished millions. His story has been scripted in a number of Hollywood movies and a Spanish biopic, The Motorcycle Diaries, that won numerous awards and loud critical appreciation.

Vikas Sinha, a Delhi University student, thanks his tees for what he learnt about the icon. "Once, I thought he was a singer. But when I got to know about him, I was left awestruck. His life was a solid mould of aspirations, courage and sacrifice."

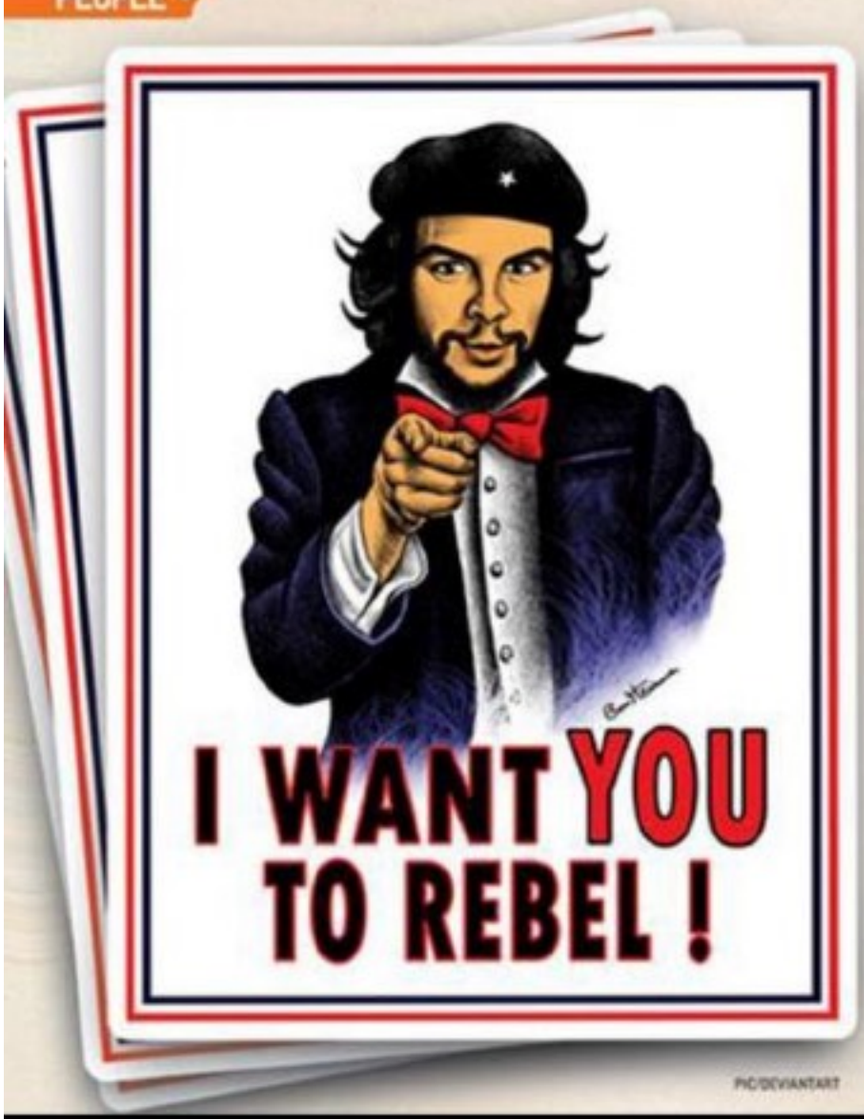
How he has remained the symbol of radical chic for so long isn't a matter of surprise. He's an embodiment of all that youth stands for — intellectualism, rebellion, socialism, and eventually martyrdom. Even corporates trade him for their white collar once out of office. "I can't keep my hands off Che. He's the only guy who keeps my sanity in place," declares Nand Singh, CEO of an online marketing agency. "As they say, he's like Christ". Amen.

## GUEVARA GUIDE FOR DUMMIES

Ernesto "Che" Guevara (June 14, 1928 – October 9, 1967), commonly known as El Che or simply Che, was an Argentine Marxist revolutionary, physician, author, intellectual, guerrilla leader, diplomat, military theorist, and major figure of the Cuban Revolution. As a young medical student, Guevara travelled throughout Latin America and was transformed by the endemic poverty he witnessed. His experiences and observations during these trips led him to conclude that the region's ingrained economic inequalities were a result of monopoly capitalism, neocolonialism, and imperialism, with the only remedy being world revolution. Time magazine named him one of the 100 most influential people of the 20th century.

## GRAB GLAM CHE TEES AT

- Janpath
- Sarojini Nagar Market
- Tibetan Market, Majnu Ka Tila
- Palika Bazaar
- Myntra.com




PIC/DEVIANTART

**If we wish to express what we want the men of future generations to be, we must say: Let them be like Che! If we wish to say how we want our children to be educated, we must say without hesitation: We want them to be educated in Che's spirit! If we want the model of a man, who does not belong to our times but to the future, I say from the depths of my heart that such a model, without a single stain on his conduct, without a single stain on his action, is Che!** — FIDEL CASTRO

**I think anyone who buys a T-shirt of Che has gotta be cool. If I see someone with a Che T-shirt, I think, 'He's got good taste'** — BENICIO DEL TORO (PLAYED GUEVARA IN THE 2008 BIOPIC CHE)

# A patent for PSP phone. BT says it's just a VOIP enabled device. The Sony-Ericsson PSP Mobile Phone?

By Deepak Jha

More than 20.5 million units of PSP (PlayStation Portable) were sold by July last year generating millions in software revenues. The UK PSP Magazine reports that more than 7000 PSP titles will be available this year. It's clear that gamers across the globe love this portable gaming station. And with more than 2.7 billion mobile phone users worldwide, a convergence of the two successful technologies might create a revolution of sorts. Ever thought of a PSP with an inbuilt cellphone and packaged digicam?



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# Into the Rave

Deepak Jha

Life and existence were conundrums for ancient philosophers; the modern day problems have altered since but the premise remains the same. Rave is one such modern enigma that we attempt to explore.

Optimism by SIDBI, Midday, Hindu Metro Plus, XG Mag, Eternal Solutions, Sopan Step, TOI Food Guides